```
Output:
O:3:"Foo":3:{s:4:"name";s:3:"foo";s:15:"FootypeString";s:15:"Instance of
Foo";s:9:"*family";a:2:{s:3:"cat";s:4:"Jess";s:6:"humans";a:2:{i:0;s:4:
"Anna";i:1;s:4:"Paul";}}}
data|O:3:"Foo":3:{s:4:"name";s:3:"foo";s:15:"FootypeString";s:15:"Instance
of Foo";s:9:"*family";a:2:{s:3:"cat";s:4:"Jess";s:6:"humans";a:2:{i:0;s:4:"
Anna";i:1;s:4:"Paul";}}}
```

Be aware that only named classes or instances of `stdClass` are serializable. Anonymous classes cause `serialize()` to emit an error:

```
// index.php

session_start();

$_SESSION['data'] = new Class {
    private string $cat = 'Jess';
};
```

```
$ curl --cookie 'PHPSESSID=3fe1329aa9a3575373814ebf8aa59857' http://
localhost:8080/index.php
...
Uncaught Exception: Serialization of 'class@anonymous' is not allowed
```

Other serialization handlers are available. The `session.serialize_handler = php_binary` ini directive switches to a binary format (which is faster and will save you some storage space), and `session.serialize_handler = wddx` will use the Web Distributed Data eXchange format, although you are unlikely to see this in installations of PHP beyond 7.4 (PHP 7.4 removed WDDX from core PHP and moved it instead to the PECL repository; the PECL package is currently not maintained). You can even write your own if you wish. Let's look at that next.

OOP API

PHP offers a (somewhat) object-oriented API in addition to the handful of session functions we've seen so far. The class that does the most work is `SessionHandler`, which is defined as follows: